

Food preservation trivia

Category	Trivia game - Spin the wheel - Table engagement
Skill level	Beginner - "Grab & go." No food-preservation expertise needed; the answers and fun facts are printed on the cards and shown on the tablet. Can be run with zero technology using the printed cards.
Audience	All ages - Kids (under 10), Tweens (10-14), Teens (14-18), and Adults. Each age group has its own questions, so it works for the whole family.
Setup time	5-10 minutes

DESCRIPTION

A spinning wheel of 8 food-preservation topics (Food Safety, Canning Fruits, Canning Tomatoes & Salsas, Low Acid Foods, Pickling, Jams & Jellies, Freezing & Cold Storage, and Dehydrating & Smoking). A visitor spins the wheel (on a tablet) or picks a topic (with printed cards), you choose their age group, and they answer a trivia question. Each card shares a fun fact to talk about. It draws people to the MFP table and starts friendly conversations about safe home food preservation.

MATERIALS NEEDED

Digital version (tablet)

- A tablet (an iPad works best), charged, turned sideways (landscape).
- The trivia wheel open on the tablet: sign in to the MFP Volunteer Resource Hub, tap "Toolkit," then "Play on tablet" on the Food preservation trivia card. (Tip: tap "Open full screen" and add it to the home screen for one-tap launch.)
- Optional but helpful: a tablet stand, and a portable battery or charger.

Printed version (no technology needed)

- Printed question-card decks. Each deck = one topic + one age group (20 cards), color-coded by topic. Print the topics/age groups you expect.
- Optional: a physical spinner, or a bowl/jar to draw a card, or simply let the visitor pick a color.

Both versions

- Table, tablecloth, and MFP / OSU Extension signage.
- Optional take-home educational handouts (tested recipe cards, OSU Extension resource list).
- This Activity guide on the table for quick reference.

SETUP

1. Decide whether you are running the digital wheel, the printed cards, or both. (Both is great - printed cards are your backup if the tablet dies.)
2. Digital: charge the tablet fully. Open the trivia wheel and do one practice spin to confirm it works. Turn screen brightness up. Optional: turn on Guided Access (iPad Settings -> Accessibility) so taps stay inside the app.
3. Printed: print the decks on white card stock, "actual size," double-sided flipping on the SHORT edge so the answer lines up on the back; then cut them apart. Sort each deck by its color, band it, and label it with the topic and age group.
4. Set this Activity guide (and any take-home handouts) where you can reach them.

ACTIVITY DIRECTIONS

Running the DIGITAL wheel

1. Welcome the visitor and invite them to spin.
2. Tap the round "SPIN" button in the center of the wheel (or tap the wheel). Wait for it to stop on a topic.
3. Ask how old the player is, then tap their age group: Kids, Tweens, Teens, or Adults.
4. Read the question out loud. The three answer choices are on the screen.
5. Let them answer by tapping a choice - or tap "Reveal answer." The correct answer turns green.
6. Read the "Fun fact" and talk about it together. Invite a follow-up question for a Master Food Preserver.
7. Tap "Next spin" and you are ready for the next visitor.

Running the PRINTED cards (no tablet)

1. Let the visitor pick a color (topic), draw a card, or spin a physical spinner.
2. Pick the deck that matches their age group.
3. Draw the top card and read the question and the three choices.
4. Flip the card over for the correct answer, the fun fact, and the source.
5. Share the fun fact and chat about it.
6. Put the used card at the back of the deck and continue.

VOLUNTEER NOTES

- You do NOT need to be a food-preservation expert. The correct answers and fun facts are printed on every card and shown on the tablet - just read them as written.
- Accuracy matters: this is food-safety content. Read answers exactly as written and do not improvise canning, pickling, or safety advice. For deeper questions, refer the visitor to a Master Food Preserver or the MFP Volunteer Resource Hub.
- Keep it positive and low-pressure - the goal is fun and conversation, not testing. There are no prizes; playing and learning is the point.
- When there is a line, keep it to one or two questions per person.
- For young kids, use the Kids deck, read slowly, and celebrate every try.
- Not comfortable with the tablet? That is completely fine - switch to the printed cards. The game plays exactly the same.
- Simple tablet help: To start, tap the round SPIN circle in the middle. If the screen goes dark, tap it to wake it up. If the app seems stuck, close it and reopen it from the home screen. It keeps working even without internet once it is open. Keep it plugged in or on a battery.
- Sanitize hands and surfaces as needed, and restock take-home handouts.